ENGLISH C1 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Substitution with so, not and do so

Replace propositions or verb phrases with so, not, do so and related substitutes instead of repeating full clauses. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use substitution with so, not and do so to maintain cohesion while signalling exactly what kind of constituent is being replaced while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Replace propositions or verb phrases with so, not, do so and related substitutes instead of repeating full clauses.

MODEL

Will the policy work? I hope so, but the evidence does not prove it will.

think/hope/suppose + so/not | do so = substitute verb phrase

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main substitution with so, not and do so patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses maintain cohesion while signalling exactly what kind of constituent is being replaced.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in conversation, formal procedure and concise analytical prose.

Build meaning before form

Replace propositions or verb phrases with so, not, do so and related substitutes instead of repeating full clauses.

What substitution with so, not and do so communicates

Replace propositions or verb phrases with so, not, do so and related substitutes instead of repeating full clauses.

The central purpose is to maintain cohesion while signalling exactly what kind of constituent is being replaced. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

Will the policy work? I hope so.	a whole positive proposition replaced by so
Will costs rise again? We hope not.	a negative proposition replaced economically
Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.	a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: think/hope/suppose + so/not | do so = substitute verb phrase. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “Will the policy work? I hope so, but the evidence does not prove it will.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Positive proposition	think/hope/suppose + so	Will the policy work? I hope so.
Negative proposition	hope/suppose + not	Will costs rise again? We hope not.
Verb-phrase substitute	do so	Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a whole positive proposition replaced by so	Positive proposition
a negative proposition replaced economically	Negative proposition
a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse	Verb-phrase substitute

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in conversation, formal procedure and concise analytical prose. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03
think/hope/suppose	so/not	do so = substitute verb phrase

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: maintain cohesion while signalling exactly what kind of constituent is being replaced.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits conversation, formal procedure and concise analytical prose.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Positive proposition	think/hope/suppose + so	Will the policy work? I hope so.
Negative proposition	hope/suppose + not	Will costs rise again? We hope not.
Verb-phrase substitute	do so	Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

Will the policy work? I hope so.	a whole positive proposition replaced by so
Will costs rise again? We hope not.	a negative proposition replaced economically
Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.	a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use so after every verb that takes a content clause.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not form every negative substitute as do not.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use do so where ordinary auxiliary ellipsis is more natural and required.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a whole positive proposition replaced by so?

OPTIONS Will the policy work? I hope so. · Will costs rise again? We hope not. · Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a negative proposition replaced economically?

OPTIONS Will costs rise again? We hope not. · Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support. · Will the policy work? I hope so.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse?

OPTIONS Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support. · Will the policy work? I hope so. · Will costs rise again? We hope not.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “Will the policy work? I hope so.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a whole positive proposition replaced by so · a negative proposition replaced economically · a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “Will costs rise again? We hope not.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a negative proposition replaced economically · a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse · a whole positive proposition replaced by so

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse · a whole positive proposition replaced by so · a negative proposition replaced economically

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“Will the policy work? I hope so.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Positive proposition / Negative proposition / Verb-phrase substitute · Gap 2: a whole positive proposition replaced by so / a negative proposition replaced economically / a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“Will costs rise again? We hope not.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Negative proposition / Verb-phrase substitute / Positive proposition · Gap 2: a negative proposition replaced economically / a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse / a whole positive proposition replaced by so

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Verb-phrase substitute / Positive proposition / Negative proposition · Gap 2: a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse / a whole positive proposition replaced by so / a negative proposition replaced economically

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a whole positive proposition replaced by so: _____. Choose the model that expresses a negative proposition replaced economically: _____. Choose the model that expresses a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse: _____. Choose the model built with think/hope/suppose + so: _____. Choose the model built with hope/suppose + not: _____. Choose the model built with do so: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support. · Will costs rise again? We hope not. · Will the policy work? I hope so.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

Will the policy work? I _____. Will costs rise again? We _____. Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to _____ should contact support. State the full structural pattern for Positive proposition: _____. State the full structural pattern for Negative proposition: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “I hope that the policy will work.” using the Positive proposition pattern to express a whole positive proposition replaced by so.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “We hope that costs will not rise again.” using the Negative proposition pattern to express a negative proposition replaced economically.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Applicants unable to verify their identity should contact support.” using the Verb-phrase substitute pattern to express a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “I hope that the policy will work.” using the Positive proposition pattern to express a whole positive proposition replaced by so.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Positive proposition to express a whole positive proposition replaced by so, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Negative proposition to express a negative proposition replaced economically, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Verb-phrase substitute to express a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

Will the policy work? I hope so.

Positive proposition is the best match because a whole positive proposition replaced by so.

A2

Will costs rise again? We hope not.

Negative proposition is the best match because a negative proposition replaced economically.

A3

Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.

Verb-phrase substitute is the best match because a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse.

A4

a whole positive proposition replaced by so

The Positive proposition pattern communicates a whole positive proposition replaced by so.

A5

a negative proposition replaced economically

The Negative proposition pattern communicates a negative proposition replaced economically.

A6

a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse

The Verb-phrase substitute pattern communicates a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Positive proposition / a whole positive proposition replaced by so

The structure belongs to the Positive proposition pattern. Its communicative purpose is a whole positive proposition replaced by so.

B2

Negative proposition / a negative proposition replaced economically

The structure belongs to the Negative proposition pattern. Its communicative purpose is a negative proposition replaced economically.

B3

Verb-phrase substitute / a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse

The structure belongs to the Verb-phrase substitute pattern. Its communicative purpose is a previously mentioned action replaced in formal discourse.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

Will the policy work? I hope so.

Positive proposition: think/hope/suppose + so.

C2

Will costs rise again? We hope not.

Negative proposition: hope/suppose + not.

C3

Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.

Verb-phrase substitute: do so.

C4

Will the policy work? I hope so.

Positive proposition: think/hope/suppose + so.

C5

Will costs rise again? We hope not.

Negative proposition: hope/suppose + not.

C6

Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.

Verb-phrase substitute: do so.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

hope so

Positive proposition requires “hope so” in this model. think/hope/suppose + so.

D2

hope not

Negative proposition requires “hope not” in this model. hope/suppose + not.

D3

do so

Verb-phrase substitute requires “do so” in this model. do so.

D4

think/hope/suppose + so

Positive proposition is built as think/hope/suppose + so.

D5

hope/suppose + not

Negative proposition is built as hope/suppose + not.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

Will the policy work? I hope so.

think/hope/suppose + so. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended positive proposition effect.

E2

Will costs rise again? We hope not.

hope/suppose + not. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended negative proposition effect.

E3

Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support.

do so. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended verb-phrase substitute effect.

E4

Will the policy work? I hope so.

think/hope/suppose + so. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended positive proposition effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

Will the policy work? I hope so. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses think/hope/suppose + so accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

Will costs rise again? We hope not. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses hope/suppose + not accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

Applicants must verify their identity before submitting; those unable to do so should contact support. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses do so accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____